

Akshay Merchant

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SUMMARY

Data Engineer with 8+ years of experience building scalable data pipelines, cloud data platforms, and automated data-quality solutions across technology, consulting, and financial services. Expert in Python, SQL, and AWS, with a track record of delivering \$120K in annual savings, repurposing 10,000+ hours, reducing data defects by 99%, and preventing 100,000+ delivery incidents. Skilled at translating complex business needs into reliable, production-ready data solutions.

EXPERIENCE

Amazon, Luxembourg, LU

Business Intelligence Engineer 2 (Data Engineering & Platform) - Engineering Services

October 2023 – June 2026

- **Designed and deployed the backend data integration strategy for a new project management platform**, integrating and migrating disparate data sources into a centralized data warehouse using AWS DMS including CDC based real-time streaming replication, S3, RDS, Redshift, and Airflow; implemented source-to-target validation and monitoring to enable reliable reporting, **delivering \$120K in annual savings and repurposing 10,000+ hours annually**.
- **Led a global data governance and quality initiative across 10 teams**, diagnosing recurring data defects and standardizing data-quality controls, validation, ownership, and documentation practices; **reduced data defects by 99% and eliminated 400 hours of manual rework annually**, improving reliability of critical downstream data assets and AI/ML inputs.
- **Led design and implementation of a centralized headcount-allocation platform** using AWS RDS, S3, Lambda, SQL owning backend database architecture, **legacy data and reporting migration across 10 applications, eliminated \$190K in annual licensing costs, and saved 500 maintenance hours per year**.
- **Partnered with 20+ customer teams as a technical data and analytics partner**, translating ambiguous operational requirements into scalable data solutions, technical roadmaps, and architecture recommendations; evaluated data readiness, technical feasibility, project value, and dependencies and presented solution options to senior leadership.
- **Served as the technical SME for SQL, data architecture, and data engineering**, advising teams on data modeling, query optimization, solution design, and implementation approaches; **delivered technical training and standardized coding best practices across 20+ teams**.
- **Conducted 75+ technical and behavioral interviews** across SQL, data architecture, problem-solving, and stakeholder management; recognized for interview excellence and delivered interviewer trainings to improve candidate experience.

Business Intelligence Engineer - Engineering Services & Alexa

November 2019 - October 2023

- **Built and managed automated Python/SQL data pipelines and delivery-health forecasting workflows for Alexa** using AWS S3, RDS, with SLA monitoring and operational scorecards to track expected versus actual performance against SLA targets, diagnosed variance drivers, and surfaced emerging risks; **enabling 50+ customer teams to identify delivery risks in real time and prevented more than 100,000 data under-delivery incidents**.
- **Led the deployment and integration of Metabase with internal AWS data infrastructure**, establishing automated configuration, access controls, logging, and usage monitoring; **scaled adoption across 20+ cross-functional teams, increased platform adoption 3x, and repurposed 500 hours annually**.

PricewaterhouseCoopers LLP (PwC), Virginia, USA

August 2018 – August 2019

Experienced Associate - Risk & Compliance

- **Designed and implemented a transaction-monitoring framework for an IT services client** using SQL, Python, R, and PowerBI to analyze travel and expense activity, identify high-risk transactions, prioritize investigations, and translate complex risk patterns into actionable insights for global compliance stakeholders; **reduced client exposure by \$10M annually and supported policy and compliance decisions**.

EDUCATION

London School of Economics and Political Science, Certificate, AI Leadership

August 2026 – Present

University of Illinois at Chicago, Master of Science, Business Analytics

August 2016 – May 2018

University of Mumbai, Bachelor of Engineering, Information Technology

August 2012 – May 2016

SKILLS

Data Engineering: ETL/ELT, dbt, data integration & migration, workflow orchestration, data modeling, data warehousing, data validation, data quality, governance, observability, SLA monitoring.

Cloud & Platforms: AWS (S3, RDS, Redshift, DMS, Athena, CloudWatch, Kinesis, Glue, Lambda), Airflow, Git, CI/CD.

Programming: Python, SQL, R.

Analytics & BI: Power BI, Tableau, QuickSight, Metabase.

Technical Leadership: Solution architecture, requirements discovery, technical roadmapping, stakeholder management.